

The clear word for kids: a new simplified paraphrase

Genesis 1

In the beginning God made the heavens and the earth. When He first made the earth, He made it out of nothing and set it spinning in space. It had no light and was covered with water. But the Holy Spirit was there watching over it.

3-5. Then God said, "Let there be light," and there was light. God looked at the light and was pleased.

Then He separated the light from the darkness. He called the light Day and the darkness Night. This happened on the first day.

6-8. Then God said, "Let there be a sky," and there it was. The fog surrounding the earth lifted, and you could see the waters. God called the sky Heaven. This happened on the second day.

9-10. Then God said, "Let the waters come together in different places and let dry land appear," and it did.

God called the dry land Earth, and the waters He called oceans.

11-13. Then God said, "Let there be grass, plants, and trees," and that's what happened. Just like that, the whole earth was covered with grass, plants, and trees. And it looked good.

This happened on the third day.

14-19. Then God said, "Let there be two lights in the sky, one for the day and one for the night. Let them shine on the earth." And that's what happened. God spoke, and there were two great lights. He made the stars, too. God put these lights in the sky to shine on the earth to divide the day from the night. This happened on the fourth day.

20-23. Then God said, "Let the waters be full of fish, large and small, and let birds fly in the sky." So God made all kinds of fish and all kinds of birds. And what He saw made Him happy. He blessed the fish and the birds and told them to multiply. This took place on the fifth day.

24-25. Then God said, "Let animals appear on the earth, large and small, and also creeping ones." And that's what happened. God made all of them, and when He saw what He had done, it made Him happy.

26. Then God said to His Son, "Let Us make people who look like Us, and put them in charge of all the animals and fish and birds."

27. So God created a man and a woman. He blessed them and said,

28. Have children and take charge of all the animals and fish and birds. 29. For food I have given you fruit and grains from seed-producing trees and plants.

30. The animals and birds will eat whatever else the earth produces.

31. On the sixth day God looked at what He had made, and it looked good. He was very happy.